Pattern Headings: Art

H 1148

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A. Recent Revisions

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

B. Types of headings covered

Headings for individual art forms in the fine arts as well as art and art forms qualified by nationality, region, ethnic group, or time period.

Examples:

Drawing

Art, French

Painting, German

Iron sculpture, Japanese

Sculpture, Southeast Asian

Arts, Māori

Hispanic American art

Landscape painting, Medieval

Sculpture, Modern

C. Types of headings not covered

The category does not include the heading ***Art***, headings qualified by religion, nor headings for the decorative arts, performing arts, or architecture. The subdivisions in this list may be used for these categories if allowed by other instructions sheets or established editorially as appropriate to the topic.

Examples:

Buddhist art

Pottery

Theater

Architecture, Modern

D. Conflicts

Any subdivision listed here can be used as a free-floating subdivision under any heading belonging to the category if it is appropriate and no conflict exists in the subject authority file. Subject authority records may exist for headings employing variant phrases or subdivisions equivalent to subdivisions on this list.

LC practice: If an exceptional variant form is to be retained, make a UF reference from the equivalent free-floating subdivision form following the procedures in H 195 if the reference does not yet exist. Otherwise, submit a proposal to change the variant form along with all bibliographic records requiring correction following the procedures in H 193.

E. New subdivisions

Establish new subdivisions under ***Art, Italian*** whenever possible. Establish subdivisions appropriate only to the art of China, Japan, or Korea under ***Art, Chinese***; ***Art, Japanese***; or ***Art, Korean***.

F. Period subdivisions

Note: These period subdivisions are not free-floating under unqualified headings for art forms, such as ***Drawing***, nor under headings for art forms qualified by time period, such as ***Sculpture, Modern***.

F.1. General period subdivisions

Subdivisions in this list are established under ***Art, Italian*** and may be used under headings for art and art forms of all nations, regions, and ethnic groups except those headings for art and art forms of China, Japan, and Korea. If there are specific headings where these subdivisions are not appropriate, establish the appropriate subdivision under the specific heading.

- $y 10th century
- $y 11th century
- $y 12th century
- $y 13th century
- $y 14th century
- $y 15th century
- $y 16th century
- $y 17th century
- $y 18th century
- $y 19th century
- $y 20th century
- $y 21st century

F.2. Chinese art

Use the period subdivisions listed below under headings for art forms qualified by the adjective ***Chinese***.

- $y To 221 B.C.
- $y Qin-Han dynasties, 221 B.C.-220 A.D.
- $y Three kingdoms-Sui dynasty, 220-618
- $y Tang-Five dynasties, 618-960
- $y Song-Yuan dynasties, 960-1368
- $y Ming-Qing dynasties, 1368-1912
- $y 20th century
- $y 21st century

F.3. Japanese art

Use the period subdivisions listed below under headings for art forms qualified by the adjective ***Japanese***.

- $y To 794
- $y To 1600

- $y To 1868
- $y Heian period, 794-1185
- $y Kamakura-Momoyama periods, 1185-1600
- $y Edo period, 1600-1868
- $y 19th century
- $y 1868-
- $y Meiji period, 1868-1912
- $y 20th century
- $y Taishō period, 1912-1926
- $y 21st century

F.4. Korean art

Use the period subdivisions listed below under headings for art forms qualified by the adjective ***Korean***.

- $y To 935
- $y To 1900
- $y Koryŏ period, 935-1392
- $y Chosŏn dynasty, 1392-1910
- $y 19th century
- $y 20th century
- $y 21st century

G. List of topical subdivisions

This list of subdivisions provides free-floating subdivisions used specifically for art headings. Additional subdivisions may be used from the general list of free-floating subdivisions in H 1095. These subdivisions may be used following free-floating or established period subdivisions, except as noted below.

Note: The scope notes included below may not reflect the full text as found in Classification Web Plus, as it includes information not relevant to art headings. The copy of the scope note as found in Classification Web Plus is authoritative.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Appreciation	Yes	Use as a topical subdivision under individual art forms and headings for national and ethnic art.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Attribution		Use as a topical subdivision under individual art forms and headings for national or ethnic art.
$x Catalogs		Use as a topical subdivision under types of objects, including art objects, collectors' items, etc., for works about listings of those objects that have been produced, that are available or located at particular places, or that occur on a particular market, often systematically arranged with descriptive details, prices, etc., accompanying each entry.
$x Conservation and restoration	Yes	Use as a topical subdivision under types of art objects, etc., for works on preserving and restoring those items.
$x Copying		Use as a topical subdivision under individual art forms and headings for national or ethnic art.
$x Expertising	Yes	Use as a topical subdivision under headings for art forms and under types of art objects, types of architecture, and types of buildings.
$x Foreign influences		Not valid under period subdivisions. Use as a topical subdivision under art forms for works on general outside cultural influences on those topics.
$x Forgeries	Yes	Use as a topical subdivision under types of art objects, documents, etc.
$x Influence		Use as a topical subdivision under forms and movements in the visual arts for works discussing their influence.
$x Reproduction		Use as a topical subdivision under individual art forms and headings for national or ethnic art for the processes of producing images of the art.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Technique		Use under individual art forms and headings for national or ethnic art for works on artistic technique.
$x Themes, motives		Use as a topical subdivision under names of individual persons and individual literary and art forms.

H. List of form subdivisions

LC practice: In 2026, the use of form subdivisions was phased out. Library of Congress catalogers assign Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT) to bring out the form(s) and/or genre(s) of the resource being cataloged. Therefore, the form subdivisions maintained on this list are not available for use by Library of Congress catalogers. Catalogers at institutions external to LC may use them as dictated by their own institutional policies.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$v Catalogs		Use as a form subdivision under types of objects, including types of merchandise, art objects, products, publications, collectors' items, technical equipment, etc., for listings of those objects that have been produced, that are available or located at particular places, or that occur on a particular market, often systematically arranged with descriptive details, prices, etc., accompanying each entry.
$v Chronology		Use as a form subdivision under headings for art for lists of dates of events pertinent to the subject in order of their occurrence.

Revision history

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.